

Finding Evidence

Workbook 2 - Apply - Focused practice

Directions

Treat each item as close-choice practice. Preserve scope, certainty, and the exact job of each piece of evidence.

Exercise 1

A clinic argues that evening appointments help patients who cannot leave work during the day. The report includes total evening visits, a survey about work conflicts, patient satisfaction ratings, and the number of parking spaces.

Task: Which evidence is most direct?

- A. The total number of evening visits.
- B. The survey showing how many evening patients reported daytime work conflicts.
- C. High satisfaction ratings.
- D. The number of parking spaces.

Exercise 2

A library says self-service pickup lockers reduce waiting at the service desk.

Task: Which evidence would best test that claim?

- A. Locker color preferences.
- B. Average service-desk wait times before and after locker use, measured during similar hours.
- C. The number of books owned by the library.
- D. A survey asking whether patrons like technology in general.

Exercise 3

A supervisor claims a short training video improved correct use of a safety form. The report says 93 percent watched the video, form errors declined, and a new form layout was introduced the same week.

Task: Which detail most directly supports improvement, while also showing why causation remains uncertain?

- A. Ninety-three percent watched the video.
- B. Form errors declined after the change, but the form layout changed at the same time.
- C. The video was six minutes long.
- D. Supervisors prefer video training.

Exercise 4

A council member says a new crosswalk would help pedestrians reach a bus stop more safely.

Task: Which evidence package would be strongest?

- A. Pedestrian counts, near-miss reports, and observations of where people currently cross.
- B. A photograph of the bus color.
- C. A list of nearby shop names.
- D. A survey asking whether residents generally support public transportation.

Answer reasoning

Check your reasoning, not only your answer.

For every question, compare your reasoning with the explanation. If you missed the item, identify the exact step where your reasoning changed the source or used evidence for the wrong job.

Exercise 1

Best answer: B. The survey showing how many evening patients reported daytime work conflicts.

Why: The claim is specifically about work preventing daytime attendance; the survey measures that barrier directly.

Exercise 2

Best answer: B. Average service-desk wait times before and after locker use, measured during similar hours.

Why: It directly measures the stated outcome while controlling for time-of-day differences.

Exercise 3

Best answer: B. Form errors declined after the change, but the form layout changed at the same time.

Why: The decline supports improvement, while the simultaneous redesign means the video cannot be isolated as the only cause.

Exercise 4

Best answer: A. Pedestrian counts, near-miss reports, and observations of where people currently cross.

Why: Together, those sources directly address use, risk, and crossing behavior at the proposed location.

Mistake check

For every miss, label the reason: wrong claim, evidence mismatch, too broad or too certain, reasoning gap, source or format confusion, or rushed reading. Then write one sentence explaining what you will check next time.